

God stands forever” (Isaiah 40:8). To ‘stand’ forever, it must be preserved forever. {Psalm 102:18 and 1 Corinthians 10:11}

Matthew 5:17-18 are part of the so-called ‘Sermon on the Mount’, delivered by Sovereign Jesus while He walked this earth. “Do not suppose that I came to destroy the Law or the Prophets; I did not come to destroy but to fulfill. For assuredly I say to you, until heaven and earth pass away, not one iota nor one tittle shall pass away from the Law until everything happens.” The Lord here makes an impressively strong statement about the preservation through time of the precise form of the Sacred Text. Since our only access to the meaning is through the form, any alteration in the form will alter the meaning. (One of the most effective ways of annulling a commandment is to corrupt the Text—something Satan understands quite well.) “It is easier for heaven and earth to pass away, than for one tittle of the Law to fail” (Luke 16:17). “Heaven and earth will pass away, but my words will by no means pass away” (Luke 21:33). Sovereign Jesus declares that His words have eternal validity, and are therefore on a par with God’s written Revelation (see Psalm 119:89).

In Matthew 4:4 Sovereign Jesus rebuts Satan, quoting Deuteronomy 8:3. “It is written: ‘Man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word coming out of God’s mouth’.” If we are to live by ‘every word’, then every word must be kept available.¹ Notice also Deuteronomy 29:29, “the secret things belong to the LORD our God, but those which are revealed belong to us and to our children forever, that we may do all the words of this law”. “All the words” includes each individual word that contributes to the whole; and for the three hundredth generation to obey them all, they all must still be available. Consider also Isaiah 59:21—“As for Me”, says the LORD, “this is My covenant with them: My Spirit who is upon you, and My words which I have put in your mouths, shall not depart from your mouth, nor from the mouth of your descendants, nor from the mouth of your descendants’ descendants”, says the LORD, “from this time and forevermore”. “My words” includes each individual word that contributes to the whole, and they are to be available “from this time and forevermore”, which includes all intervening generations. Revelation 22:18-19 also emphasizes the individual words.

I submit that the references presented above may reasonably be understood to constitute a declaration that the Sovereign Creator intends that His written Revelation be available to all generations until the end of the

¹ Luke 4:4 is precisely parallel, where less than half a percent of the extant Greek manuscripts, of objectively inferior quality, omit “but by every word of God” (lamentably followed by NIV, NASB, LB, TEV, etc.).